

S ANUKRITI

Senior Economist, Development Research Group, The World Bank
Washington, DC | sanukriti@worldbank.org | [Website](#)

EMPLOYMENT

2022–	Senior Economist, Development Research Group, The World Bank
2024–	Co-lead, Center for Research on Women and Jobs, The World Bank
2020–2022	Economist, Development Research Group, The World Bank
2013–2020	Associate Professor of Economics, Boston College

EDUCATION

2013	Ph.D. Economics, Columbia University <i>Advisers:</i> Pierre-André Chiappori and Cristian Pop-Eleches
2010	M.Phil. Economics, Columbia University
2009	M.A. Economics, Columbia University
2004	M.A. Economics, Delhi School of Economics
2002	B.A. (Honors) Economics, St. Stephen's College, University of Delhi

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

2024–	Board Member, WEE-Connect, BRAC Institute of Governance and Development
2024–2026	Member, Technical Advisory Group, FP-Impact Consortium
2022–	Board Member, WEE-DiFine, BRAC Institute of Governance and Development
2021–	Research Fellow, IZA@LISER

RESEARCH FIELDS

Development Economics; Economics of Gender and the Family; Political Economy.

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles

1. Son Preference, Intergenerational Household Dynamics, and Women's Mental Health in India (*with Catalina Herrera-Almanza, Shahadat Hossain, and Mahesh Karra*), **Journal of Development Economics**, 183, September 2026.
2. Female Leaders and Intrahousehold Dynamics: Evidence from State Elections in India (*with Bilge Erten and Priya Mukherjee*), **American Economic Journal: Economic Policy**, 18(3):441–475, August 2026.
3. Bring a Friend: Leveraging Financial and Peer Support to Improve Women's Reproductive Agency in India (*with Catalina Herrera-Almanza and Mahesh Karra*), **Journal of Development Economics**, 180, March 2026.
4. Contraceptive Concordance (*with Catalina Herrera-Almanza, Mahesh Karra, and Sarah Vincent*), **Studies in Family Planning**, 56(3):532–549, September 2025.
5. Filling the Gaps: Childcare Laws for Women's Economic Empowerment (*with Lelys Dinarte-Diaz, Maria Montoya-Aguirre, and Alena Sakhonchik*), **AEA Papers and Proceedings**, 115:689–694, May 2025.
6. The Influence of COVID-19 on Young Women's Labor Market Aspirations and Expectations in India (*with Catalina Herrera-Almanza and Sophie Ochmann*), **AEA Papers and Proceedings**, 114:243–247, May 2024.
7. Convincing the Mummy-ji: Improving Mother-in-Law Approval of Family Planning in India (*with Catalina Herrera-Almanza, Mahesh Karra, and Rocío Valdebenito*), **AEA Papers and Proceedings**, 112:568–572, May 2022.
8. Saving for Dowry: Evidence from Rural India (*with Sungoh Kwon and Nishith Prakash*), **Journal of Development Economics**, 154, January 2022.

9. On the Quantity and Quality of Girls: Fertility, Parental Investments, and Mortality (*with Sonia Bhalotra and Eddy H. F. Tam*), **The Economic Journal**, 132(641):1–36, January 2022.
10. Curse of the Mummy-ji: The Influence of Mothers-in-Law on Women in India (*with Catalina Herrera-Almanza, Praveen Pathak, and Mahesh Karra*), **American Journal of Agricultural Economics**, 102(5):1328–1351, September 2020.
11. Democracy and Demography: Societal Effects of Fertility Limits on Local Leaders (*with Abhishek Chakravarty*), **Journal of Human Resources**, 54(1):79–121, Winter 2019.
12. Women’s Worth: Trade, Female Income, and Fertility in India (*with Todd J. Kumler*), **Economic Development and Cultural Change**, 67(3):687–724, April 2019.
13. Financial Incentives and the Fertility-Sex Ratio Trade-Off, **American Economic Journal: Applied Economics**, 10(2):27–57, April 2018.

Books Chapters and Reports

1. The Promise of Artificial Intelligence, **World Development Report 2026**, The World Bank. Core team member.
2. Who Cares? Care Work and Women’s Labor Market Outcomes in Iraq, Jordan, and Lebanon (*with Silvia Redaelli, Paola Sandra Buitrago Hernandez, and Tala Ismail*), **The 2nd State of the Mashreq Women Flagship Report**, The World Bank, March 2023.
3. Reshaping Social Norms about Gender: A New Way Forward (*with Maurizio Bussolo and Ana Maria Munoz Boudet*), **South Asia Economic Focus**, The World Bank, April 2022.
4. Marriage Markets in Developing Countries (*with Shatanjaya Dasgupta*), book chapter in **Oxford Handbook on Women and the Economy**, ed. Susan L. Averett, Laura M. Argys, and Saul D. Hoffman, Oxford University Press, 2017.
5. Economic Incentives and the Fertility-Sex Ratio Trade-Off, book chapter in **Policy Challenges from Demographic Change in China and India**, ed. Karen Eggleston, Brookings Institution Press, 2015.

WORKING PAPERS AND MANUSCRIPTS

1. Can Effective Policy Implementation Alter Political Selection? Evidence from Female Legislators in India (*with Rossella Calvi and Abhishek Chakravarty*), World Bank Policy Research Working Paper No. 10654; IZA Discussion Paper No. 16639. Under review.
2. Son Preference and Missing Women (*with Rossella Calvi*), June 2026; in preparation for the *Oxford Handbook on the Economics of Fertility and Reproductive Health*.
3. Evaluating the Impacts of Training and Access to Digital Platforms on Female Domestic Workers in Bangladesh (*with Maurizio Bussolo, Jean Lee, Siddharth Sharma, and Anaise Williams*), **Journal of Development Economics**, conditionally accepted based on pre-results review. Manuscript in preparation.
4. Digital Job Search and the School-to-Work Transition: Evidence from a Field Experiment in India (*with Catalina Herrera-Almanza and Sophie Ochmann*), Manuscript in preparation.

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

- Keeping Girls in School: Evaluating the Case Management System in Zambia (*with Aanchal Bagga and Kathleen Beegle*)
- The Measurement and Evolution of Son Preference in India (*with Sakshi Gupta, Nistha Sinha, and Yongkun Yin*)
- Social Networks and Women’s Economic Empowerment (*with Thomas Gautier, Eeshani Kandpal, and Juni Singh*)
- Revisiting the Curse of the Mummy-ji: Mothers-in-Law and Women’s Welfare (*with Catalina Herrera-Almanza and Mahesh Karra*)

RESEARCH FUNDING AND HONORS

2025–2026	World Bank Research Support Budget Grant (USD 15,000)
2024	DEC VPU Team Award for the <i>Development Impact</i> blog
2022–2023	World Bank Research Support Budget Grant (USD 198,000)
2021–2022	World Bank Knowledge for Change Program Grant (USD 199,000)
2021–2022	World Bank Research Support Budget Grant (USD 99,999)
2021	EMERGE–UCSD Grant (USD 19,895; with Lelys Dinarte and Iva Trako)
2020–2021	World Bank Research Support Budget Grant (USD 89,597)
2019	<i>World Bank Economic Review</i> Excellence in Refereeing Award
2018–2019	Research Fellow, Women and Public Policy Program, Harvard Kennedy School
2017–2018	Northeastern University Tier-I Grant (USD 47,800; with Catalina Herrera-Almanza, Matt Simon, Mahesh Karra, and Praveen Pathak)
2016–2017	Boston College Research Incentive Grant (USD 13,805)
2013	Best Paper in Applied Economics by a Young Researcher, 67th European Meeting of the Econometric Society

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- **2026-27:** Conference on “Culture, Social Norms, and Inequality” at the University of Zurich
- **2025-26:** Center for Global Development, Georgetown University, GWU India Conference, NEUDC, World Bank SAR-GIL Seminar
- **2024-25:** Advances with Field Experiments Conference (LSE), Annual Bank Conference on Development Economics (CGD), British Society for Population Studies Annual Conference (University of Bath), Heterodoxy Meets Policy Workshop (SOAS London), IEA-WB Conference Gender Norms and the Law, World Bank SAR-GIL Seminar, Workshop on Household Economics in Developing Countries (Dickinson College)
- **2023-24:** CII Global Economic Policy Forum, CEPR Development Economics Annual Symposium, Inclusion Economics India Center at IFMR, NEUDC, Oxford CSAE Conference, Society of Government Economists’ Seminar
- **2022-23:** 100 Years of Economic Development Conference (Cornell), 3rd Brazilian Meeting on Family and Gender Economics, American University, National University of Singapore, University of Maryland - College Park (ARE), WEAI Conference
- **2021-22:** Ashoka University, BREAD-Stanford Conference on Behavioral Economics and Development, IIM (Bangalore), ISI Delhi Conference, NEUDC, World Bank Policy Research Talk, Workshop on Networks and Development (Naples)
- **2020-21:** Delhi School of Economics, LSE, New York University, World Bank (DECRG), WB Gender Learning Week, Toulouse Economics & Biology Workshop
- **2019-20:** CESifo (Munich), Colby College, Delhi University, SUNY Binghamton, University of Essex, University of Sussex, University of Oxford, World Bank
- **2018-19:** AEA Meetings, Tufts University, Ashoka University Conference, NBER Development Meetings (Pre-conference), Williams College, University of Washington Seattle
- **2017-18:** Brown University (PSTC), ISI Delhi Conference, NEUDC, PHS Research Workshop, North American Winter Meetings of the Econometric Society, UC Berkeley (Demography), UC Santa Barbara, University of Southern California, University of South Florida, UConn Development Economics Conference, Wellesley College
- **2016-17:** DSE Winter School, Fordham University, Georgetown University, IFPRI, ISI Delhi, ISI Delhi Conference, SIEPR Gender Workshop, University of Connecticut
- **2015-16:** AEA-Econometric Society Joint Meeting, COSME Gender Economics Workshop, Delhi School of Economics, EEA Meetings, Econometric Society European Meetings, IGC Political Economy Workshop, ISI Delhi Conference, Laval University, PAA Meetings, SEA Meetings, NEUDC, UCSD, UC San Francisco (Reproductive Health)
- **2014-15:** DIAL Conference (Paris), Northeastern University, PAA Annual Meeting, PopPov, RAND, UCLA
- **2013-14:** Boston University, Cornell University (PAM), European Meeting of the Econometric Society, Indian School of Business, ISI Delhi Conference, Peking University (Stanford Center), PopPov (Nairobi), SEA Annual Meeting, ZEW Workshop (University of Mannheim), Stanford University, University of Connecticut
- **2012-13:** Barnard College, Boston College, Columbia University, Heinz College (Carnegie Mellon), IFPRI,

IIES (Stockholm), Ohio State University, Simon Fraser University, NEUDC, Workshop on Households and Risk (Georgia State University), Stanford School of Medicine, UC Santa Cruz, Williams College

- **2011-12:** PAA Annual Meeting, Becker Friedman Institute (University of Chicago)
- **2010-11:** Delhi School of Economics, NEUDC

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

Journal Refereeing

American Economic Review; American Economic Journal: Applied Economics; American Economic Journal: Economic Policy; American Economic Review: Insights; American Journal of Health Economics; American Political Science Review; BMJ Global Health; Demography; Economic Development and Cultural Change; The Economic Journal; Journal of Development Economics; Journal of Development Studies; Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization; Journal of Economic Growth; Journal of Economic Literature; Journal of the European Economic Association; Journal of Human Resources; Journal of Labor Economics; Journal of Policy Analysis and Management; Journal of Public Economics; Population and Development Review; Quarterly Journal of Economics; Review of Economics and Statistics; Review of Economic Studies; World Bank Economic Review; World Development.

Grant Review

BRAC Institute of Governance and Development; 3ie; The World Bank.

Conference and Workshop Organization

- Co-organizer, Mend the Gap in Economic Opportunities in Europe and Central Asia: Second Edition, Rome, 2026.
- Co-organizer, Women and Jobs in Africa Policy Research Workshop, Accra, 2025.
- Co-organizer, Women and Jobs in Latin America and the Caribbean Policy Research Workshop, Bogotá, 2025.
- Co-organizer, Women & Jobs debate and seminar series, Center for Research on Women and Jobs, The World Bank, 2025–2026.
- Co-organizer, 9th South Asia Economic Policy Network Conference on Social Norms and Gender Inequality, The World Bank, 2022.
- Co-organizer, Workshop on Son Preference: Drivers, Evidence Gaps, and Policies, The World Bank, 2021.
- Program Committee Member, NEUDC, multiple years.
- Program Committee Member, Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development, ISI Delhi, multiple years.

Other Service

2023– CSWEP Liaison, The World Bank

2020– Gender Focal Point, Development Research Group, The World Bank

RESEARCH DISSEMINATION AND PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

Articles, Blogs, and Commentary

- What's up with gender norms? Development Impact, May 2026
- Electing women improves healthcare for female constituents, but can trigger a domestic violence backlash, VoxDev, April 2026
- Peer support boosts reproductive agency where vouchers fall short, VoxDev, April 2026
- From marriage penalties to child penalties: how development reshapes women's work, Development Impact, April 2026
- AI Chatbots, Development Impact, October 2025
- How should we measure household wealth in our surveys? Development Impact, July 2025
- Male-dominated editorial boards: Part 2, Development Impact, October 2024
- Competence vs gender, VoxEU Talk, July 2024
- Male-dominated editorial boards, Development Impact, July 2024
- Family - Part 2, Development Impact, June 2024
- How to collect data on social networks, Development Impact, May 2024
- Family, Development Impact, April 2024

- Notes from the field: From Lusaka to the Copperbelt (with Kathleen Beegle), *Development Impact*, September 2023
- Can Childcare Legislation Increase Women's Participation in the Paid Labor Force? (with Lelys Dinarte-Diaz and Maria Montoya-Aguirre), *Care Talk*, September 2023
- Bring a friend: Leveraging financial and peer support to improve women's reproductive agency (with Catalina Herrera-Almanza and Mahesh Karra), *Ideas for India*, August 2023
- Convincing the Mummy-ji: Improving mother-in-law approval of family planning in India (with Catalina Herrera-Almanza, Mahesh Karra, Rocío Valdebenito), *Ideas for India*, August 2023
- Childcare regulation and women's participation in the labor force (with Lelys Dinarte-Diaz, Maria Montoya-Aguirre, and Alena Sakhonchik), *Development Impact*, June 2023
- (How) Should I stratify when randomizing at the group level? (with Antoine Deeb and Florence Kondylis), *Development Impact*, February 2023
- Son preference: Why we should care about it (with Maurizio Bussolo and Nistha Sinha), *Let's Talk Development*, October 2021
- Evolution of dowry in rural India: Evidence from 1960-2008 (with Sungoh Kwon and Nishith Prakash), *Ideas for India*, July 2021
- How dowry influences household decisions in rural India (with Sungoh Kwon and Nishith Prakash), *Ideas for India*, July 2021
- Evolution of dowry in rural India: Evidence from 1960-2008 (with Sungoh Kwon and Nishith Prakash), *Let's Talk Development*, June 2021
- How dowry influences household decisions in rural India (with Sungoh Kwon and Nishith Prakash), *Let's Talk Development*, June 2021
- How mothers-in-law influence women's social networks and reproductive health (with Catalina Herrera-Almanza and Mahesh Karra), *Ideas for India*, August 2020
- On homecoming of migrant workers in India (with Siddharth Ramalingam), *The Print*, June 2020
- Indian women can't go out and socialise because of their mothers-in-law: Study (with Catalina Herrera-Almanza, Mahesh Karra, Praveen Pathak), *The Print*, December 2019
- Financial incentives and the fertility-sex ratio trade-off in India, *Ideas for India*, June 2018
- Even money won't make Indians prefer daughters over sons, *The Print*, March 2018
- How Female Foeticide Has Influenced Fertility and Parental Investments in Girls (with Sonia Bhalotra and Hiu Tam), *VoxDev*, September 2017
- How Female Foeticide Has Influenced Fertility and Parental Investments in Girls (with Sonia Bhalotra and Hiu Tam), *Ideas for India*, September 2017
- Assessing the Impact of the Two-Child Limit for Panchayat Members (with Abhishek Chakravarty), *Ideas for India*, March 2015
- Leveraging Political Aspirations (with Abhishek Chakravarty), *Mint*, March 2015

MEDIA AND INTERVIEWS

Selected research coverage: *The Economist*, BBC, CNN, *The Hindu*, *LiveMint*, *Business Standard*, *The Print*, and other outlets.

Interviews and Podcast Appearances

- Interviewed on *Rocking Our Priors*, A podcast by Alice Evans, August 2022
- Interviewed on *Behind the Scenes of Econ Research*, Podcast by Women in Economics and Policy, June 2022
- Delving into women's isolation, *World Bank Feature Story*, March 2022
- Meet The Economist Who Did A Research On Saas-Bahu Relationships, Interview with *She The People*, April 2020
- #TURU (The Un Regulated Underbelly), Podcast appearance on *SynTalk*, December 2019

TEACHING

Ph.D.	Topics in Development Economics, Boston College Lecturer, IGC–ISI Summer School in Development Economics, 2020
Undergraduate	Topics in the Economics of Gender, Boston College Development Economics and Policy, Boston College International Trade, Columbia University (summers 2010 and 2011) Statistical Methods, St. Stephen's College, University of Delhi (2005–2006)

ADVISING

Ph.D. Dissertation Committees

2018	Jacob Penglase (co-chair), San Diego State University
2018	Lauren Velasco (reader), Georgia State University
2018	Solvejg Wewel (reader), Analysis Group
2020	Sajala Pandey (chair), Analysis Group
2021	Navin Kumar (co-chair), Harris School of Public Policy, University of Chicago
Ongoing	Ngoc Nguyen (reader)
Ongoing	Priyanka Sarda (reader)

Undergraduate Advising

2016–2017	Carolyn Ruh (Economics); Giffuni Family Prize for outstanding thesis
2015–2016	Maria Boria (Economics); Giffuni Family Prize for outstanding thesis
2015–2016	Claire Horrigan (Faith, Peace, and Justice Minor)
2014–2015	Margaret Bennett (Faith, Peace, and Justice Minor)